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## Aligning LLMs to New Zealand Public Values

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### INFORMATION FOR PARTICIPANTS [for Anonymous Surveys]

Hello

My name is James Thompson and I am a Masters student in Artificial Intelligence at Te Herenga Waka—Victoria University of Wellington. This research project is work towards my Masters degree.

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#### He aha te whāinga mō tēnei rangahau / What is the aim of the project?

Large Language Models (LLMs)—the technology behind tools like ChatGPT—are increasingly making decisions that affect people’s lives. However, the values these models follow are typically set by private companies rather than the public. This project aims to develop and test a method for tuning LLMs to behave in ways that better reflect New Zealanders’ values.

Your participation will help us understand whether the public prefers the behaviour of LLMs that have been aligned to public values compared to unaligned models. This research has been approved by the Te Herenga Waka—Victoria University of Wellington Human Ethics Committee [Hōkai application reference number to be added].

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#### Ka pēhea tō āwhina mai / How can you help?

You have been invited to participate because you are a member of the New Zealand public. If you agree to take part, you will complete an anonymous online survey. The survey will present you with short scenarios describing how an AI system behaved in a particular situation. For each scenario, you will be asked to rate how much you agree with the AI’s behaviour on a simple scale. You will also be asked a few questions about your own values. The survey will take approximately 15 minutes to complete.

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#### Ka ahatia ngā kōrero ka tukuna mai / What will happen to the information you give?

This research is anonymous. This means that nobody, including the researchers, will be aware of your identity. By answering the survey, you are giving consent for us to use your responses in this research. Your answers will remain completely anonymous and unidentifiable. Once you submit the survey, it will be impossible to retract your answer. Please do not include any personal identifiable information in your responses.

Personal details will be collected separately only for those who wish to enter the prize draw. All personal details will be received separately from the survey data and will be held in confidence. This ensures that your answers to the survey questions will not be linked to your identity.

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#### He aha ngā hua o te rangahau / What will the project produce?

The information from my research will be used in my Masters research project and may also be used in academic publications and conference presentations.

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**Mehemea ngā pātai, he raruraru rānei, me whakapā ki a wai / If you have any questions or problems, who can you contact?**

If you have any questions, either now or in the future, please feel free to contact me or my supervisor:

**Student:**

Name: James Thompson

Email: [thompsjame1@myvuw.ac.nz](mailto:thompsjame1@myvuw.ac.nz)

**Supervisor:**

Name: Dr Andrew Lensen

Role: Primary Supervisor

School: School of Engineering and Computer Science

Email: [andrew.lensen@vuw.ac.nz](mailto:andrew.lensen@vuw.ac.nz)

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**He kōrero whakamārama mō HEC / Human Ethics Committee information**

If you have any concerns about the ethical conduct of the research you may raise this with the HEC Convenor, Te Herenga Waka—Victoria University of Wellington, by emailing [human-ethics@vuw.ac.nz](mailto:human-ethics@vuw.ac.nz) or phoning the University's Service Centre on 0800 04 04 04.

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